

SURAH YUSUF SELF QUESTIONS PT.1

What are some of Yusuf AS's known virtues?

- Honor and distinction from Allah
- Noble lineage
- Respect from the Prophet SAW
- Beauty and charm
- Dream interpretation
- Patience + tawakkul

What is the context of revelation for this surah?

- Late Makki surah
- The Kuffar of Mecca went to the Jews to consult
- Jews in Madinah sent back the question of how Yaqub AS's family ended up in Egypt

What does Allah say is the purpose of Surah Yusuf?

- In the last ayat of the surah Allah affirms that the purpose of this surah is three things:
 - 1) "lesson for people of intelligence"
 - 2) guidance
 - 3) mercy

What are huroof mugatta? What are the two views regarding them?

- Disjoined letters
 - 1) Only Allah knows their meaning. Better not to ask as its mutashabih (unclear)
 - 2) The meaning is worth pondering, but there is no agreement on it between scholars

What dream did Yusuf AS have in his childhood? How is it interpreted by scholars?

- 11 stars, the sun and the moon prostrating to him
- 11 stars = his brothers
- Moon = his father
- Sun = his "mother" (maternal aunt)

OR power and wealth

What was Yaqub AS's advice? What concerns did he have?

- Do not share with your brothers
- Feared Shaytan would encourage them to plot something evil

How did Yaqub AS interpret the dream?

- That Allah is choosing Yusuf AS to be a prophet, through which he will gain two things: interpretation of events (dreams + literal events) and worldly success (for himself + family)

★ What wisdom can we draw from Yaqub AS's advice to Yusuf AS? ★

- **Caution in self promotion**: it compromises the purity of our intentions. Better to keep our spiritual status private.

When beginning the story of how the brothers plotted, the surah says there are signs for "the inquisitive ones". Who is that referring to?

- Arabs of Mecca/ rabbis of Madina as an answer to their question about how Yaqub's family ended up in Egypt
- The Prophet SAW, for whom the story of Yusuf was a comfort.

What was the brothers initial plot to get rid of Yusuf AS? Why did they change their minds?

They initially planned to kill or abandon him somewhere far away. However by Allah's will, another brother intervened and suggested they instead drop him in a well and allow him to be picked up by travellers.

★ Why did the brothers plot against Yusuf specifically? What wisdom can parents draw from this story? ★

- The brothers believed that Yusuf (and Benjamin by association) were more beloved to their father. They believed themselves to be more worthy of his love.
- Equal treatment of children: Parents must treat their children equally. Unequal treatment can shatter their unity and love for each other.

★ Define hasad. Explain its consequences and treatment. ★

Hasad: • the desire to see someone stripped of a blessing, which leads them to malicious intents / behavior.
• commonly translated as "jealousy"
• an ailment of the soul

Consequences:

- clouds judgement
- interferes with doing good deeds
- discontentment, which draws the anger of Allah.

★ Serious disease of the heart.
Must be treated promptly.
★ Not the same as ghibta (envy)

Treatment:

- careful self analysis
(enmity, pride, denial, hopelessness, wickedness)
- Identifying related behaviors and resisting acting on them
- Act in a loving way towards the person.

How did Yusuf's brothers appeal to their father to let them take Yusuf with them? How did Yaqub express his hesitance?

1) Guilt tripping: "You do not feel safe while we are well wishers"

- 2) Pretense of a fun trip: told Yaqub its so that Yusuf can eat and play
- 3) Guarantee of safety: they say they will keep him safe and act like Yaqub assuming otherwise is an insult to their strength/intentions.

Yusuf's Hesitance: He claimed to fear a wolf devouring Yusuf. Hinted at his awareness for their malice / potential neglect but did not cause a confrontation.
The wolf may have been the brothers themselves.

Explain Yusuf's experience before / in the well. What was revealed to him?

- The brothers abused him and then threw him into the well, where he then made dua earnestly.
- Revelation: He will one day tell them what they did. Allah consoled him with this promise of eventual success / return

What did the brothers tell their father? How'd he respond?

Brothers Excuse: That a wolf devoured him while they were racing. They also tried to guilt their father, and presented a shirt with animal blood on it

Yaqub's Response: "Your souls have embellished a matter for you."
And Sabr jamil, Allah is the only one whose help can be sought

What is شَحْ ? Why is it harmful?

شَحْ : Greed / Ambition specifically for wealth and power in dunya. Its main harm: makes people not care

about morals. Anything and everything becomes ok.

What does the book say is the true source of hatred?
Why is it important to know?

- The Source is unjustified anger
- It is important for a believer to know what causes their anger so they don't act regrettably

Why did Allah give human beings anger? What are some improper causes of anger and how can we combat them?

<u>Purpose:</u>	<u>Improper Causes:</u>	<u>Treatments:</u>
• to recognize and act on injustice • self preservation • self defense	• arrogance • frustration • ignorance • greed	• recognize if its inappropriate • remember Allah • change position • make wudu

What lesson can we learn from Yaqub's response to losing Yusuf?

★ Engaging with the Creator: We should try to understand that the situation is a test from Allah and turn to him for comfort and help. ★

SURAH YUSUF QUESTIONS PT. 2

How did Yusuf leave the well?

- A caravan passing by found him while collecting water.

What are the two opinions on who sold him?

opinion 1: the brothers saw the caravan and sold him first

★ opinion 2: the travellers pretended he was their slave and sold him. ^{Preferred}

Who bought Yusuf and how did he plan on treating him?

Qitfir. Referred to as Aziz (person of authority).

He did not want to treat him like a slave, rather as a potential successor

What does Allah affirm he gave Yusuf in Ayat 19-22?

- firm position
- wisdom / knowledge
- interpretation of events
- (All of this despite the plots: showing Allah's planning)

What lessons can we learn from Yusuf finding a suitable home in Egypt?

1. Allah's gifts remain regardless of any plots
 2. Problems can lead to opportunities
 3. When Allah tests, he compensates
 4. Ihsan is the gateway to knowledge and wisdom
- ★ Bonus: the journey was Allah's tarbiyah of Yusuf ★

ZULAIKHAS PLOT

Who tried to seduce Yusuf? How did she do it?

- The surah refers to her as "the one in whose house" Yusuf was staying.
- Her name is Zulaykha
- She took him into a room and closed the door. Tafsir mentions there were 7 doors and they were locked

What is an etiquette we can implement having learned from the incident between Zulaykha and Yusuf?

Avoid seclusion with non-mahrams: seclusion creates the opportunity for sin especially between 2 people of the opposite gender.

How did Yusuf respond in the face of sin? Why was it a severe test?

Yusuf did 3 things:

- 1) Sought refuge with Allah
- 2) Reminded himself and Zulaykha of his master / her husband
- 3) "Wrongdoers never succeed"

Factors of the test:

- He's a young, single man
- Zulaykha had authority over him
- It could have been kept secret
- There was minimal risk / punishment

→ Yusuf ultimately chose to fear Allah

Some opinions assert that the phrase Zulaykha said to Yusuf, "Come You" is not arabic. Explain why that is not true.

- The Quran itself asserts that it is an arabic Quran.
- Any words presumed to be non arabic are likely both arabic and present in other languages.
- This is the opinion of most scholars.

What is taqwa and how did Yusuf demonstrate it when he was in the room with Zulaikha? What can we learn from him?

Taqwa: is a fear and consciousness of Allah.

Yusuf demonstrated it by: 1) Verbally seeking refuge in Allah 2) Running away to the doors

Lesson: Taqwa to the best of ones ability. Yusuf ran even though the doors were locked. He tried as hard as he could to resist. Allah will hold you accountable to the full extent of your ability.

How were Yusuf and Zulaikha discovered? What was Zulaikha's response, and what can we learn from that?

The door opened and "her warden" (Aziz, her husband) was behind the door. Zulaikha responded by pinning the blame on Yusuf and requesting a punishment for him.

Lesson: Evil is only masked with another evil

In order to cover up her first evil, she lied and accused an innocent person. Evil deeds lead to more evil just as good deeds lead to more good.

How was Yusuf's innocence proven to his master? What lesson can we draw about how Allah protects the upright?

- A witness from Zulaikha's family suggested that if the shirt was torn from the back it meant she was the liar
- The shirt was torn from the back. Aziz recognized its meaning and asked for Yusuf's pardon in it.

★ Lesson: Allah provides proof of truth and innocence. Yusuf did not have to go to length, Allah cleared his accusations for him because he was upright. ★

What did Zulaikha do after her accusation proved unsuccessful? What lesson can we learn?

She invited the women of the city who were gossiping to come and see Yusuf.

Lesson: Sins have a way of disgracing people. Because she had no excuse, she then tried to shift the blame on Yusuf's good looks. She ended up boasting about it.

The women who were criticizing Zulaikha. What do we learn from them?

- Sincere advisors will not backbite, they were not sincere and their reaction showed
- True advice is given in confidence

How did Zulaikha double down? What does that show us about unrestrained desire?

Zulaikha doubled down by threatening to imprison Yusuf if he does not give in.

Lesson: Desires can become obsessions.

How did Yusuf respond to Zulaikha's threat? Why was that decision a wise one?

- Asked Allah to send him to prison
- It's the lesser of two harms

What does Yusuf's imprisonment show us about Allah?

- Allah is the only one who can prevent harm. He was innocent but still ultimately imprisoned.
- There are no "roses without thorns"

Someone might look at Yusuf and think he's guilty. Explain how Allah reminds us to think twice.

- Yusuf was innocent, and he was imprisoned because of the situation. This shows that we shouldn't pass any premature judgment.

What does Yusuf specifically say he will become if not removed from the situation?

Ignorant. He refers to the possibility of falling into sin as making him ignorant.

Bc Sins are a form of ignorance

What role do dreams play in helping Yusuf get out of prison?

* both men accused of trying to kill the king. One is innocent.

In prison Yusuf interprets two dreams:

- 1) One man: pressing wine → will serve wine to his master
- 2) Another man: bird eating bread → will be crucified and pecked at by birds from the top of his head

The first man later served the king, and remembered Yusuf for his wise dream interpretation when the king had his dream. That was what allowed Yusuf his stage with king/opportunity to prove himself and eventually get freed.

How did Yusuf AS respond to the prisoners who came to him trusting in his character and wisdom? What lessons can we draw?

- Yusuf responds by giving them *dawah*. He reminds them that knowledge only comes from Allah and that they should worship him alone. The lesson from this is that there is always a need for *dawah*.
- We can also see from how the men trusted Yusuf that Allah protects the honor of pious people in all conditions.

What did Yusuf tell the man who was released? Why him? What were the results of that instruction and why?

- "Tell your master about me" bc
- He knew it would reach the king

Yusuf stayed in prison for a few more years, and *mufasssin* say it's because he sought people's help before Allahs. However, it still worked in his favour.

Result: First shaytan made the man forget to tell, out of genuine mistake.

How does islam categorize dreams? How and when are

they shared / interpreted?

- 1) True dreams: From Allah, sent to prophets
- 2) Good dreams: From Allah. Come from honesty/piety.
a reason to be happy. share wisely
- 3) Unintelligible dreams: Subconscious or Shaytan. don't share
- 4) Bad dreams: From Shaytan, should be forgotten

Conditions for sharing:

- the person is knowledgeable
- they care/know about you
- they have good character

What dream did the King have and how did it reach Yusuf?

- 7 fat cows eaten by 7 lean ones
- 7 green grains and 7 dry ones
- His former prison mate remembered him and asked^{to see} him for interpretation.
- The King's vassals all thought it was random but the King knew better

How did Yusuf interpret the King's dream? What else does he say and how does that prove his status?

Yusuf gave both the interpretations and the solutions

- 1) 7 fat cows → 7 years of prosperity → must farm for future
7 green ears
- 2) 7 lean cows → 7 years of famine → eat from saved food /
7 dry ears ration the portions
- 3) A year of rain → must plant seeds in advance

Through this Yusuf proves that he's not just someone who can interpret dreams, but that he also has the knowledge on how to act.

How did the King respond to Yusuf's interpretation? What were the results of his investigation?

The King sought out Zulaikha to find out what happened. She testified that Yusuf is innocent and truthful.

What are two explanations for the ayat that follow Zulaykha's admission? p.162

The ayat are about how Allah does not guide betrayers and how souls are tempted by evil.

They're either 1) the words of Zulaikha 2) the words of Yusuf

↳ she had not slandered Yusuf	↳ his duty towards his master
↳ she recognized her nafs	↳ humility in the face of evil

What is the difference between the ruh and the nafs?

Ruh = soul

- created before bodies
- grouped before birth
- extracted at death

✦ both are concepts only Allah has full knowledge of.

Nafs = self

- used interchangeably with ruh
- refers also to temperament
- can evolve based on good/evil
- must be disciplined

As Yusuf's innocence is proven, what lessons can we draw about how he handled himself in the face of accusation?

- Protect your own reputation
- Stay focused on facts, you don't need to overcompensate
- Stay level-headed even in great victories
- Be humble (innocent not perfect)

How did the King move forward with Yusuf? What did Yusuf choose and what can we learn from this?

- King decided to appoint Yusuf a position of leadership due to his trustworthiness
→ Lesson: Solutions are always valued
- Yusuf picked to be treasurer since he is 1) Protective 2) Knowledgeable
→ Lesson: Recognize your strengths

What does Allah say he gave Yusuf through this? Who is the reward of the hereafter reserved for?

- Allah gave Yusuf "authority in that land" and freedom of movement
- Reward of the hereafter is for those who
 - 1) believe
 - 2) have taqwa

What is the overall message Allah is sending by showing us how Yusuf's imprisonment ended?

When you leave things for Allah, he replaces it with something better.

What conditions did Yusuf give his brothers when they came to Egypt? Why did they come and how did they treat him?

They came to Egypt in pursuit of food, since neighboring regions were also struggling. They treated him like a person of authority since they did not recognize him.

Yusuf also spoke to them like he did not recognize them. He asked them to bring their brother (Benjamin, who had stayed back) to prove that they weren't taking extra shares. He set the condition that he would not give them more food if they failed to do so.

What steps did Yusuf take to make sure Benjamin was brought to Egypt? Why?

1) Told the brothers he wouldn't give them more food unless they brought him

2) Secretly put their goods (that they gave as payment) back into their bags so they want to come back

These would increase the chances of them wanting / being able to come back
Motivation for both the brothers and Yaqub.

How did the brothers request their fathers permission to take Benjamin? What was their attitude like?

They claimed to Yaqub that their measure had been "withheld". They had an attitude of entitlement, and tried to convince their father with promises that they would protect Benjamin and bring more food back. Despite having already received food without payment, they still wanted more.

What was Yaqub's condition on the brothers for sending Benjamin?

That they swear by Allah that they will bring him back, unless they are overpowered.

What else was Yaqub worried about on this second journey, according to mufasssin? What instructions did he give and what does Allah say about that advice?

- Yaqub was worried about ayn (evil eye)
- He instructed them to enter through separate gates to avoid drawing unnecessary attention, while leaving them in Allah's hands.

• Allah says that while Yaqub is a "man of knowledge" this instruction was only fulfilling his urge and would not protect them from the will of Allah.

What is ayn? Mention its effects and how we can protect ourselves. ^{and others!}

Ayn = evil eye.

Protection of self: dua/adhkar, Surah Falaq / Nas
Keep things private!! Avoid drawing attention

Effects = severe harm on the thing being looked at

Protection of others: Avoid looking more than need, say mashallah / allahumma barik

Treatment: Ghusl / Washing, Ruqya (preferably by yourself)

Who was the first person to find out Yusuf's identity and how did he find out?

Benjamin. Yusuf lodged with him and revealed it himself.

Explain the full plot of the drinking vessel. What was it, where did it end up, and how did it interfere with the brothers.

- 1) Drinking vessel belonged to the king
- 2) Was placed in Benjamin's bag on purpose
- 3) Noticed missing, prize for its return
- 4) The brothers were stopped and asked

The vessel was specifically for measuring grains. could not be replaced.

How was the punishment of the drinking vessels theft decided? What was Allah's wisdom in that?

They asked the brothers what the punishment should be if they are found to be thieves. If the punishment had been by the laws of Egypt, the outcome would have been very different. But since the brothers chose according to their laws, the punishment was specifically for Benjamin to become a slave.

Allah himself says "This is how we planned for Yusuf"

Explain the brothers' reaction to the goblet being found in Benjamin's bag. How did Yusuf respond?

The brothers react by implying theft runs in their (Yusuf and Benjamin's) blood. Yusuf stays silent and remarks it actually turns them in a worse position (in Allah's eyes).

What is the double entendre in Yusuf saying that sending Benjamin back is "unjust", when the brothers ask to switch?

At face value, punishing someone who did not commit the crime is unjust. The hidden meaning is that sending Benjamin back with his other brothers would actually be the more cruel thing to do.

How did the brothers plan to explain things to their father? What complicated it?

The brothers planned to explain that his son (not "their brother") had

stolen. Even though they were telling the truth they knew they lost trust bc:

1) They had
lost Yusuf

2) They made
an oath
on Allah

3) They broke
the oath

One of the brothers stayed back out of responsibility.

What is Yaqub's response both times he loses his son? What wisdoms can we draw from him?

Sabr jamil. "Splendid patience". We can see how Yaqub's patience was founded in absolute trust in Allah, despite grief. He didn't complain, just turned to Allah immediately for comfort.

What happened to Yaqub after he received the news of Benjamin?

His eyes turned white (he went blind) from suppressing his grief

Why did the brothers go back to Egypt a third time? What does that show about Yaqub?

They went back because Yusuf told them to "go find signs of Yusuf and his brother." This shows how Yaqub still had hope and had not given up despite all odds. He still knew from Allah that Yusuf was destined for more since childhood.

Yusuf revealed himself on this third visit, but did not gloat and instead forgave his brothers. What are the virtues of ghufuran?

Ghufuran: to forgive / cover up.

1) Earns us the

2) Earns us respect

3) it is a quality

forgiveness of Allah and love from people of prophets

What quality does Yusuf refer to as being associated with sin/evil, multiple times?

Ignorance. First when faced with Zulaikha and the potential of sin, then again when revealing himself to his brothers, in reference to when they abandoned him.

What are the 3 roles Yusuf's shirt plays in the Surah?

- 1) False evidence that a wolf devoured him
- 2) Evidence of innocence from Zulaikha
- 3) Healing Yaqub's eyes after he went blind from grief

How does Yusuf honor his parents once the whole family is reunited in Egypt? How is the dream he had as a child realized?

He places his parents on the throne. The whole family prostrates to him, like how he saw the sun/stars/moon prostrating in his dream.

What dua did Yusuf make after reuniting with his father?

Allow me to die as a Muslim and join me with the righteous

What note does Surah Yusuf end on? What does Allah command the Prophet SAW to do and what reassurance is he given?

It ends on

- 1) command to da'wah to the Prophet SAW
- 2) warning to Kuffar to learn from stories of predecessors
- 3) reassurance to the prophet SAW that all prophets went through similar difficulties.

✓

THE END ★ ★ ★

Make dua for me if you see this!